Shivangi Ambardar

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *Expected 2027*
Dissertation Committee: Dan Bernhardt (Co-Chair), Lena Song (Co-Chair), Alexander Bartik, Jorge Lemus.

M.S. in Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2024*

B.A. in Quantitative Economics & Mathematics, Beloit College *2021*
Full Tuition Scholarship ($200,000); Dean's List (8 semesters).

RESEARCH FIELDS

Economics of Technological Change, Media Economics, Economic History

RESEARCH

- *"Selective Technological Disruption: Evidence from TV Entry and Radio Stations"* (Job Market Paper)
  I study how U.S. radio stations responded to the arrival of television, using newly collected FCC financial records and differences in when markets got television because of the FCC's 1948–1952 freeze. Television reduced network revenue by 31.5 percent and increased local advertising revenue by 12.5 percent, with no significant change in total revenue.
- *"Spatial Diffusion of Unions: Historical Evidence from the UK"* (with Keitaro Ninomiya)
  We study the Amalgamated Society of Railway Servants, one of Britain's earliest national railway unions. Each additional infrastructure-failure accident is associated with an 8.9 percentage point higher probability that a district had an early branch, and districts sharing railway lines with early unionized districts were more likely to host branches later.
- *"Special Economic Zones and Local Economic Development in India"*
  I study India's Special Economic Zones using a spatial difference-in-differences design with 244 geocoded zones and nearly 600,000 villages. Villages within five kilometers of a zone see higher nighttime lights, manufacturing employment, and firm counts, with effects largely disappearing beyond 20 kilometers.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- *"Pricing the Airwaves: Television Entry and Radio Advertising Rates"*
- *"When Unionized Workers Arrive: Employer Responses and Workplace Outcomes"* (with Keitaro Ninomiya)

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2024–Present*
- Built firm-level panel datasets (~29,000 observations) from unstructured historical financial reports using automated Python pipelines (Azure Document Intelligence, LLM APIs), cutting manual processing by over 80%.
- Ran relevant econometric analyses in Stata (DiD, IV, panel regressions).
- Led three undergraduate research assistants across project workstreams, including digitizing new data and running validation checks on raw data.

Economist / Consultant, New York State Attorney General's Office *2025*
- Synthesized empirical research and extrapolated findings from existing studies to estimate the effects of social media regulations on minors in New York.
- Estimated benefits to minors and costs to six major social media firms, with findings incorporated into the SAFE for Kids Act's official Regulatory Impact Statement.

Data Analytics Intern, PepsiCo, Consumer Insights *2023*

- Modeled consumer purchasing patterns and built market-share forecasts across a national salty snack portfolio.
- Estimated demand elasticities for PepsiCo and rival product lines to identify pricing opportunities and risks.
- Maintained analytical databases and produced executive-ready reports on market trends and strategic implications.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2022–Present*

- Guest Research Advisor, Behavioral Economics (ECON 490), undergraduate research projects *2025–Present*
- Head Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 102) *Fall 2023–Present*
- Teaching Assistant (head TA in training), Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 102) *Spring 2023*
- Assistant Instructor, Microeconomic Theory (ECON 500), M.S. in Policy Economics (MSPE) *Fall 2022*

Beloit College *2018–2021*

Teaching Assistant, economics and statistics courses

AWARDS

1. Robert E. Demarest Memorial Teaching Award ($5,000) *2025, University of Illinois*
2. List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent *2022–2025, University of Illinois*
3. Morris & Sally Kleiner Labor Economics Prize ($3,000) *2023, University of Illinois*
4. Albert R. Topps Economics Award *2021, Beloit College*
5. McAllister Award *2019, Beloit College*
6. Alexander Award *2018, Beloit College*
7. Full Tuition Scholarship ($200,000); Dean's List (8 semesters) *2017–2021, Beloit College*

PRESENTATIONS

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

- Applied Microeconomics Research Seminar (×8)
- "AI-Assisted Digitization of Archival Records," AI Impact Workshop (2026)

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Secretary, Illini Glider Club. FAA Private Glider Pilot License (in progress).
Member, Students Advising on Graduate Education (SAGE), University of Illinois (2026).
Reviewer, Midwest International Economic Development Conference (2025).

REFERENCES

Dan Bernhardt (Co-Chair)
IBE Distinguished Professor of Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
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Lena Song (Co-Chair)
Assistant Professor of Economics
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